

Flower Dedication

The flowers adorning the sanctuary this morning are given in memory of Lenoir Stanley for her birthday.
— Debbie Madjlesi, Vicki Seago, Sally Sharlow, Ann Harland Webster, & Cathy Wheeler

Announcements

FPC Membership Class. This 4-week series is a vehicle for learning more about the Christian faith and First Presbyterian Church. Membership not only entails “who” we are, but also “what” we believe and “how” we are to serve. We will discuss the larger denomination the church is a part of, specific theological foundations, and what it means to be a part of the Body of Christ at First Presbyterian Church.
The class meets Sunday mornings — October 18 & 25, November 1 & 8 — at 9:30 a.m. in the Fellowship Hall (on the NE corner of the campus). If you have any questions or need more information, please contact the church office.

Samaritan’s Purse Shoeboxes. Collection boxes are available in the children’s wing and the side entrance by the church office. You can participate by shopping and collecting items, or by donating monetarily — each shoebox costs \$10 to ship. Items needed: small composition notebooks, pencils, small cars/trucks, puzzles, jump ropes, hair bows/barrettes/brushes/combs, underwear in larger sizes, and small stuffed animals. No liquids, candy, or food!

Those Who Serve Today

Assisting Elder — Dr. Steve Blair	Ushers — Bubba Labas, Randy Lambert, Alan Smith, & Henry Labas
Greeters — Cole & Amy Sanders	Nursery — Laura Kate Carmichiel, Bobby & Nicole Roach, Devin Butler, Lauren Butler, & Leslie Fisher
Acolytes — Brandon Giaccaglini & Betsy Butler	
Circle of Prayer — Dr. Steve Blair & Cindy Blair	
AV Engineer — Russell Smith	

Church Staff

Rev. Waring Porter - Pastor	Phyllis Sellers - Day School Director
Gregg Parker - Dir. of Discipleship	Jan Pike - Choir Director
Bobby Capps - Dir. of Outreach & Care	Malechi Doren - Accompanist
Jennifer Shipp - Dir. of Student Ministries	Teresa Tsagarakis - Administrative Assistant
Laura Kate Carmichiel - Dir. of Women’s Min. & Comm.	Sammy Allred - Bookkeeper

The Church Calendar

October 4 Session Meeting
October 7 Outdoor Movie Night: *Mary Poppins*, 6:30 p.m.
October 11 Deacons’ Meeting

Online Giving



Scan to give online



FIRST PRESBYTERIAN
CHURCH

October 4, 2026

Nineteenth Sunday after Pentecost

“To be disciples, to make disciples”

Welcome

We Are Glad You Are Here!

We are honored that you decided to join us this morning. Whether it is your first time in church, your first time in a long while, or part of your regular rhythm, we hope you will be encouraged by the fellowship with each other, and with our Lord, as we worship him together.

If this is your first time with us, please take a moment and fill out a Next Steps Card found on the back of the pew, or scan the QR code and submit it on your phone. We would love to meet you and help you get connected.

Children & Nursery

There is no Children’s Church this week during the school break, but members of our congregation will lead “A Word for the Children” during the service. Children are always welcome in worship! Children’s bulletins and crayons are available in the Narthex and at the East entrance.

Nursery rooms for infants through age 3 are in the Education Wing, with the entrance behind the playground on the west side of campus. If you have a newborn and/or are nursing your baby, please feel free to use our baby room just off the narthex — a quiet space with comfortable seating where the worship service is broadcast as well.

Our Vision & Mission

Our vision is to see lives transformed by the power of the gospel, rooted in God’s Word and the Reformed tradition, in order to create a culture of discipleship at FPC where disciples WORSHIP holistically, GROW relationally in Christ, and SERVE boldly in the world for the glory of God. Our mission is to accomplish this by “Being Disciples and Making Disciples.”

Connect With Us

Website: fpccorinth.org
Phone: 662-286-6638
Address: 919 East Shiloh Rd, Corinth, MS 38834

Sermon Notes

“*The Power of Conversion*”

Mr. Brett Butler · Acts 9:1–19

The story of Paul’s conversion is one of the greatest biblical narratives of divine grace and mercy. Saul of Tarsus was a man zealous for religion, but blind to the truth. He fiercely hated the followers of Christ, persecuted them passionately, and even consented to their deaths. Yet the Lord, who searches all hearts, saw him as a vessel that could be used for His glory. On the road to Damascus, Saul encountered the risen Christ in a dramatic, life-changing moment. The light that shone from Heaven not only blinded his eyes but illuminated his soul. The once sworn enemy of the Church became an Apostle of Christ, proving that no life is too lost for redemption.

I. Divine Encounter Brings Significant Transformation (vv. 3–5)

II. God Uses His Servants to Restore the Broken (vv. 10–11)

III. True Conversion Produces New Identity and Purpose

“*Therefore, if anyone is in Christ, he is a new creation. The old has passed away; behold, the new has come.*” — 2 Corinthians 5:17

IV. Every Convert Must Become a Witness for Christ (vv. 20–25)

GATHERING		
Our worship is a covenant conversation between God and His people. Throughout the service, God graciously speaks to us through His Word, and we joyfully respond with praise, confession, prayer, faith, thanksgiving, and obedience.		
The Piano Prelude		
Greetings & Announcements		
Call to Meditation: John 14:1 “Let not your hearts be troubled. Believe in God; believe also in me.”		
Scripture Reading	Acts 9:1–19 · Pew Bible, p. 945	
Scripture Response: Isaiah 40:6b, 8 Leader: All flesh is grass, and all its beauty is like the flower of the field; <i>All: The grass withers, the flower fades, but the Word of our God will stand forever. Amen.</i>		
Sermon: “The Power of Conversion”	Mr. Brett Butler	
Prayer of Commitment		
SENDING		
*Hymn: #345	“Leaning on the Everlasting Arms”	
*Benediction		
*Choral Benediction	“Go Now in Peace”	
*Postlude		
*Call to Worship: Psalm 100 Leader: Make a joyful noise to the Lord, all the earth! Serve the Lord with gladness! Come into his presence with singing! <i>All: Know that the Lord, he is God! It is he who made us, and we are his; we are his people, and the sheep of his pasture.</i> Leader: Enter his gates with thanksgiving, and his courts with praise! Give thanks to him; bless his name! <i>All: For the Lord is good; his steadfast love endures forever, and his faithfulness to all generations.</i>		CALL TO WORSHIP We are summoned to worship by God’s word, calling His people into His presence to honor Him in spirit and truth, opening a sacred conversation that unfolds throughout the service. We sing in response to God’s call to worship, which is a reminder that worship is at God’s initiative, not ours.
*The Hymn: #87	“May Jesus Christ Be Praised” (vv. 1–4)	MAY JESUS CHRIST BE PRAISED This beautiful hymn serves as a powerful declaration of Christ’s absolute sovereignty over every moment of our lives and all of creation. This 19th-century German hymn perfectly echoes our Reformed conviction that all of life is to be lived <i>Coram Deo</i> (before the face of God) for His ultimate glory. As we sing, we join our voices with the church universal, dedicating both our morning labors and evening rest to the praise of our reigning King.

The word “invocation” suggests that the congregation calls upon God, yet this must not be misunderstood to mean that we bring God into our presence or that His nearness depends on our request. The Lord is already present with His people before our worship begins. To “invoke” is to call upon or earnestly seek. So, we lift our voices to God, asking Him to draw near and enable us to worship Him rightly for His character and mighty works.

Our corporate confession of sin is a three-fold acknowledgement that the world is not the way it was meant to be; I am not the way I was meant to be; and we as a church are not the way we were meant to be. As we acknowledge our failures together, we testify to the world that the gospel is rooted in the faithful mercy of God alone. This is the most honest moment of our week, as we humbly agree with Scripture's claim that all have sinned and fall short of the glory of God.

Our Father, who art in heaven, hallowed be thy Name. Thy Kingdom come, thy will be done on earth, as it is in heaven. Give us this day our daily bread, and forgive us our debts, as we forgive our debtors. Lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil. For thine is the kingdom, the power, and the glory, forever. Amen.

Leader: Immediately he made the disciples get into the boat and go before him to the other side, while he dismissed the crowds. And after he had dismissed the crowds, he went up on the mountain by himself to pray. When evening came, he was there alone, but the boat by this time was a long way from the land, beaten by the waves, for the wind was against them. And in the fourth watch of the night he came to them, walking on the sea.

Leader: And Peter answered him, “Lord, if it is you, command me to come to you on the water.” He said, “Come.” So Peter got out of the boat and walked on the water and came to Jesus.

Leader: Jesus immediately reached out his hand and took hold of him, saying to him, "O you of little faith, why did you doubt?" And when they got into the boat, the wind ceased.

“May Jesus Christ Be Praised” (vv. 5–6)

God, our heavenly Father, You raised Jesus from death to life and crowned Him Lord of all. Yet, we confess that we regularly enthrone ourselves as king. Forgive our rebel hearts and treasonous ways, for we are those who regularly set our minds on earthly things instead of things above where Christ is. May Your Spirit lead us again to boast in the cross so that we might possess a sincere, pure, and undistracted devotion to our Lord, for we pray in the name of the One who possesses all authority in heaven and on earth, Jesus Christ our Lord.

“Blessed be the God and Father of our Lord Jesus Christ! According to his great mercy, he has caused us to be born again to a living hope through the resurrection of Jesus Christ from the dead, to an inheritance that is imperishable, undefiled, and unfading, kept in heaven for you.”

Glory be to the Father, and to the Son: and to the Holy Ghost; As it was in the beginning, is now, and ever shall be: world without end. Amen.

FPC MISSIONS

FPC currently provides prayer and financial support to over 50 international and domestic missionaries, along with 2 international ministry organizations and 6 local ministries. We want to introduce the congregation to several of these missionaries every month, so you can get to know them and pray specifically for them.

*Praise God, from whom all blessings flow; Praise Him, all creatures here below;
Praise Him above, ye heavenly host; Praise Father, Son, and Holy Ghost. Amen.*